MONTHLY UPDATE

Zambia: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Standards · Public debate and participation in policymaking

FINANCE
New investments

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity

DPI
Data Exchange · Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

DIGITALISATION
Rural digital data capture

TECHNOLOGY
AI

INCLUSION
Access to services · Digital divides

DATA
Open data · Use of satellite data

GEOPOLITICS
US / hyperscaler activities · India activities

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

GROW ZAMBIA AGENDA 2026-2031

- **Zambia places ICT at centre of new economic blueprint** — CAJ News Africa, 10 September 2026

  Smart Zambia to build a real-time Cabinet dashboard for the Grow Zambia Agenda 2026-2031's eight digital targets.

FRAMEWORK FOR CONTENT-CREATOR EARNINGS FROM DIGITAL PLATFORMS

- **Zambia unlocks digital earnings for creators** — ITWeb Africa, 12 October 2026

Zambia's technology and youth ministries are developing a framework for local content creators to earn from digital platforms, and are talking to Meta, TikTok and Google about the legal and technical arrangements. The President named it a priority when opening the 14th National Assembly, and a national database of creators is being compiled.

Legislation and regulation

REVOCATION OF AN OPERATOR'S LICENCES

- **ZICTA kicks out Zedmobile from Zambia's telecom market over regulatory non-compliance** — Zambia Monitor, 15 September 2026

  The communications regulator revoked an operator's network and service licences with effect from 14 September, citing persistent failures to meet regulatory, operational and financial obligations after considering the operator's representations.

ELECTRONIC COMMUNICATIONS AND TRANSACTIONS ACT NO. 4 OF 2021

- **Gov't Reviews Electronic Communications and Transactions Act** — Efficacy News, 30 September 2026

  Zambia's technology ministry opened stakeholder consultations on amending the Electronic Communications and Transactions Act of 2021, approved in principle by Cabinet in September 2025. The changes would strengthen the national public key infrastructure under ZICTA and add appeal mechanisms.

Data protection

NATIONAL CHILD ONLINE PROTECTION STRATEGY 2025-2029

- **Zambia launches Child Justice Week 2026 with a call to strengthen protection of children in digital spaces** — UNICEF Zambia, 7 October 2026

  Childline logged 1,208 online-safety cases Jan-Aug 2026, 85% involving children; UNICEF 21-country report presented.

Standards

STANDARDS TECHNICAL COOPERATION AGREEMENT WITH RWANDA

- **Zambia, Rwanda sign technical cooperation agreement to harmonise standards** — Zambia Monitor, 3 September 2026 RWANDA

  ZABS-RSB deal signed at the 32nd ARSO Assembly covers mutual recognition of conformity results.

NATIONAL PUBLIC KEY INFRASTRUCTURE AND DIGITAL TRUST ANCHOR

- **Zambia Bets on Digital Trust** — Zambia24, 7 September 2026

  The communications regulator has operationalised the National Digital Trust Anchor as national root certification authority, under the electronic communications and transactions statute. The framework is to issue and verify the certificates and signatures that establish who a person or organisation is online. No certificate count, list of subordinate authorities or accreditation route accompanies the launch.

- **Zambia launches national digital trust infrastructure** — ITWeb Africa, 9 September 2026

  Zambia and Altron Security have launched a National Public Key Infrastructure, intended as a sovereign root of trust for digital identity, electronic signatures and secure online government, with certificates carrying legal validity under the country's electronic communications and transactions law. The master cryptographic keys were generated under independently audited conditions in a purpose-built facility and are held offline, split

among several custodians so that no single body controls them. The Smart Zambia Institute's national coordinator said the launch is only the beginning and its value depends on whether government can sustain the infrastructure, fund it and get public institutions to adopt it.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

PROSECUTION OF ONLINE SPEECH UNDER THE CYBER SECURITY AND CYBER CRIMES ACT 2021

- **Court convicts vlogger Chishimba over Mwanawasa allegations** — Mwebantu, 11 September 2026

  Lusaka magistrate convicts vlogger under section 54 of the Cyber Security and Cyber Crimes Act No. 2 of 2021.

- **Mansa tailor nabbed for insulting HH on TikTok** — News Diggers, 12 September 2026

  Police in Mansa arrested a 38-year-old man over a TikTok video allegedly insulting President Hakainde Hichilema, charging him under Zambia's Cyber Crimes Act with harassment using electronic gadgets. The police statement is dated 11 September 2026, after the Secretary to the Cabinet warned that insulting the President would be prosecuted.

- **Vlogger gets 9 months for sharing screenshot about Mwanawasa's false pregnancy** — News Diggers, 15 September 2026

  Nine months for Joseph Chishimba under section 54 of the Cyber Security and Cyber Crimes Act No. 2 of 2021.

- **Police nab TikToker for saying truck drivers steal fuel, have poor hygiene** — News Diggers, 19 September 2026

  Ndola arrest of TikToker Natasha Nambeya on a truck drivers' association complaint; the charge is behind the wall.

Finance

New investments

DIGITAL ZAMBIA ACCELERATION PROJECT

- **IDEA Half-Year Implementation Progress Report: January-June 2026 and Outlook for July-December 2026** — COMESA Secretariat (IDEA project), 1 October 2026 ANGOLA DRC MALAWI ESWATINI EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  COMESA spent 9% of USD 3.71m 2026 budget by June; Angola, DRC, Malawi, Zambia, Eswatini project status.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

MOBILE AND MOBILE INTERNET SUBSCRIPTIONS

- **Giving business and citizens a smart edge** — Freight News, 3 September 2026

  ZamPortal services, 95% mobile coverage 2022-25, internet subscriptions 10.4m (2021) to 14.7m (2025).

- **Govt seeks Tech partnerships to build local capacity** — Lusaka Times, 18 September 2026

  Mobile subscriptions 20.2m to 26m and mobile money K169bn to K486bn 2021-2025; Hikvision-Avit tie-up welcomed.

AIRTEL ZAMBIA ACQUISITION OF AIRTEL TELESONIC FIBRE NETWORK

- **Airtel invests K324m in 1,300km optic fibre network** — Zambian Business Times, 21 September 2026

> Related-party deal for about 1,300 km of fibre from Airtel Telesonic, independently valued at K324.9m.

DPI

Data Exchange

REGIONAL CUSTOMS-TO-CUSTOMS DATA EXCHANGE ROADMAP

- **Five Southern African countries move to link customs data as trade corridors face pressure to cut delays** — Southern African Times, 2 September 2026 MALAWI MOZAMBIQUE SOUTH AFRICA ZIMBABWE SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Pretoria roadmap for customs-to-customs data exchange across five corridors, 24-26 August.

AFRICA ACCELERATOR FOR DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE (AA4DPI)

- **CDPI on its session at the Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, 2–3 September 2026** — Centre for Digital Public Infrastructure (CDPI), 3 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE

  Two-day accelerator session, 2–3 Sept 2026: delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone, Zambia.

- **Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure (AA4DPI)** — United Nations Development Programme, 8 September 2026 AFRICA

  UNDP has published the standing description of its Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, led jointly by the Regional Bureau for Africa and the Digital and AI Hub, which supports countries to assess digital readiness, strengthen governance, build implementation capacity and develop investment-ready programmes across digital identity, digital payments and data exchange. Its first published cohort session ran on 2 and 3 September with delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia; no budget, duration or deliverable set is published for the accelerator itself.

- **UNDP's AA4DPI Programme Deepens South-South Cooperation on Digital Public Infrastructure** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), 8 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE AFRICA

  Delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia, with African Union representatives, concluded a two-week South-South learning mission to India on digital public infrastructure. Convened under UNDP's newly launched Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, it took delegates through New Delhi, Pune and Bengaluru to examine India's digital identity, payment and data exchange systems.

GOVERNMENT SERVICE BUS

- **IDEA Half-Year Implementation Progress Report: January-June 2026 and Outlook for July-December 2026** — COMESA Secretariat (IDEA project), 1 October 2026 ANGOLA DRC MALAWI ESWATINI EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Summarised under New investments.

COMESA YELLOW CARD ONLINE SALE PILOT

- **Digital overhaul targets fraud in Sh3.5bn cross-border motor insurance market** — Business Daily (Nation Media Group), 13 October 2026 EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Online sales piloted in Zambia; phone verification in 8 countries; 340,000 cards and US$27m premiums in 2025.

Digital Identity and CRVS

INVALIDATION OF THE NATIONAL IDENTITY DOCUMENTS OF GOVERNMENT CRITICS

- **Njapau Defends Invalidation Of IDs, Names HH's Online Attackers** — Lusaka Times, 19 September 2026

  Former deputy minister confirms IDs cancelled over online criticism; count, names and legal process unstated.

MOSIP-BASED NATIONAL DIGITAL ID SYSTEM

- **IDEA Half-Year Implementation Progress Report: January-June 2026 and Outlook for July-December 2026** — COMESA Secretariat (IDEA project), 1 October 2026 ANGOLA DRC MALAWI ESWATINI EAST AFRICA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Summarised under New investments.

Digital Payments and Fintech

AUTOMATED MONITORING OF MOBILE MONEY AGENT ACTIVITY AND LIQUIDITY

- **African mobile money shifts beyond adoption** — TechTrendsKE, 4 September 2026 GHANA

  MTN mobile money executives told the group's fintech summit in Johannesburg that high adoption numbers mask weak use of savings and investment products. The Ghanaian chief executive said the platform processes more than 26 million transactions a day but that fewer than 0.3% of users actively invest; the Zambian chief executive said agent numbers were not on their own solving access and that the company had deployed artificial intelligence to monitor agent activity and liquidity to find where customers cannot get cash.

CHEQUE CLEARING

- **Zambia: Mobile Money Opened Doors. Fintech Has to Go Further** — The Fintech Times, 5 September 2026

  14.7m registered mobile-money accounts (2024, IMF FAS); 77% hold balances; Bank of Zambia phasing out cheques.

REGISTERED MOBILE MONEY ACCOUNTS AND THEIR USE

- **Zambia: Mobile Money Opened Doors. Fintech Has to Go Further** — The Fintech Times, 5 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

MOBILE-MONEY CASH-OUT AT A COMMERCIAL BANK'S ATMS

- **MoMo, FNB launch Zambia ATM cash-out** — ITWeb Africa, 17 September 2026

  MTN MoMo and FNB launched a service in Zambia letting mobile-money customers withdraw from their wallets at the bank's ATMs without a card or an account at that bank. It extends a partnership that already carried transfers between wallets and bank accounts and wallet payments at the bank's terminals.

DIRECT RENMINBI SETTLEMENT THROUGH CIPS (STANBIC BANK ZAMBIA)

- **Zambia says RMB payment system can cut trade costs, deepen China investment** — Zambia Monitor, 23 September 2026

  Stanbic Bank Zambia opens direct renminbi settlement over China's CIPS, backed by the commerce ministry.

ZAMPAY AND THE GOVERNMENT ELECTRONIC PAYMENT GATEWAY

- **Zamportal revenue crosses $500m mark** — ITWeb Africa, 1 October 2026

> Zambia's finance minister said the national services portal has collected about K9.8 billion across 572 services and 52 providers since 2019. The 2027-2029 budget call circular names the Government Service Bus and payment gateway as the state's centralised revenue-collection system.

Registries

> CONTINUOUS CIVIL REGISTRATION COVERAGE

- **Zambia : Govt. Implements Digital Civil Registration** — Lusaka Times, 3 September 2026

  3,000+ under-fives registered in Lavushimanda in four months; INRIS live in 26 districts since 2022.

Sectoral management information systems

> KEEPING GIRLS IN SCHOOL DIGITAL BENEFICIARY VERIFICATION

- **Government Trains 25 Teachers In KGS Digital Checklist Verification** — Lusaka Times, 24 September 2026

  GEWEL Keeping Girls in School checks move from paper forms to tablet app; girls now sign for themselves.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

> SMART OFFICE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **SC encourages Smart Office platform utilisation** — Lusaka Times, 4 September 2026

  Cabinet Secretary orders all public bodies onto the platform; Smart Zambia progress report due end-October 2026.

- **ZACL Becomes First State-Owned Enterprise to Adopt SMART Office** — Efficacy News, 5 September 2026

  First SOE onboarded; 406 more staff to be trained across ZACL stations by end-November 2026.

> TENDERS PUBLISHED THROUGH ELECTRONIC PROCUREMENT

- **Zambia's 103,326 Tenders Reveal the Scale of the Government Procurement Market** — Solwezi Today, 14 September 2026

  103,326 tenders published on Zambia's eGP in 2025, more than double 2024's 45,724.

> PUBLIC SERVICE FUNERAL SCHEME DIGITAL PLATFORM

- **Funeral Scheme Digital Platform To Be Rolled Out In October** — Lusaka Times, 24 September 2026

  PSMD with Madison Life, first week of Oct 2026; members register beneficiaries and track claims online.

> INTEGRATED MEDIA REPORTING SYSTEM (IMRS)

- **Govt. Launches Integrated Media Reporting System** — Lusaka Times, 25 September 2026

  Ministry-built platform to track the eight presidential priorities for the Presidential Delivery Unit; no cost stated.

> ZAMPORTAL

- **Zamportal revenue crosses $500m mark** — ITWeb Africa, 1 October 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

> DIGITAL CLIMATE ADVISORY SERVICE

- **How Zambia is building a digital climate advisory service its farmers can act on - TomorrowNow** — TomorrowNow, 6 October 2026

> Met service and agriculture ministry SMS advisories at 4x4 km; 35,000 farmers last season, 1 million targeted next.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

> CONNECTIVITY AND DIGITAL LEARNING PROGRAMME FOR 70 SCHOOLS

- **Government launches Digital Learning programme** — Lusaka Times, 15 September 2026

  Lynx Zambia Digital Inclusion; 70 schools on Starlink, solar off-grid, targets to 2031.

Technology

AI

> COUNTRY-HOSTED AI COMPUTE (UNDP AI INFRASTRUCTURE ACTIVATION)

- **Local AI compute infrastructure in Africa: Lessons from six country-hosted deployments on governance and effective use** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Regional Bureau for Africa, 17 September 2026 KENYA MALAWI RWANDA SOUTH AFRICA TOGO AFRICA

  Six-country UNDP review: 21 AI applications identified, and usable data the weakest link, not the GPUs.

> NJILA.AI CAREER-GUIDANCE PLATFORM

- **Zambia Pilots AI Career Guidance Platform to Bridge Youth Skills Gap** — Tech Africa News, 12 October 2026

  Zambia's technology ministry is piloting Njila.ai, an artificial-intelligence career-guidance platform, in the technical and vocational training system under a World Bank-backed skills project. The pilot is expected to reach more than 17,000 young people, and feedback is to decide any wider rollout.

Inclusion

Access to services

> ENTRY-LEVEL HOME FIBRE PRICE

- **Liquid Zambia cuts fibre entry price to K300 and increases speeds** — Efficacy News, 16 September 2026

  Liquid Intelligent Technologies Zambia cut its entry home fibre package to K300 a month for up to 6 Mbps and raised speeds on its other plans at unchanged prices. The company puts Zambian internet penetration at 33% without giving a source.

> MYZAMTEL SUPER APP AND KONGOLA MALAITI FINANCIAL SERVICE

- **Zamtel unveils MyZamtel Super App and two Zambia-first digital innovations** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026

  Zambia's Zamtel launched a self-care application with a build-your-own-bundle option, and Kongola Malaiti, a digital financial service reached by short code. No user figures are given.

Digital divides

> CONNECTIVITY AND DIGITAL LEARNING PROGRAMME FOR PUBLIC SCHOOLS

- **70 Zambian Public Schools to Receive Starlink Connectivity Under Three-Year Programme** — Efficacy News, 18 September 2026

> Zambia launched a three-year programme to connect an initial 70 public schools by satellite, with solar power for schools off the grid, run by the presidential delivery unit with private partners. No cost or school list is stated.

Data

Open data

> ZAMBIA NATIONAL RESEARCH REPOSITORY

- **Finance Ministry, ZamStats and UNICEF Launch National Research Repository** — Efficacy News, 17 September 2026

  Central platform for research, evaluations and knowledge products, framed against Vision 2030.

Use of satellite data

> MYTOCHONDRIA SOIL-MONITORING PLATFORM

- **Zambian Entrepreneur Thomas Lungu Brings AI and Satellite Data to Farming** — wearetech.africa, 22 September 2026

  Zambian start-up Mytochondria, co-founded in 2023 by data scientist Thomas Fred Lungu, uses satellite imagery and AI to assess soil quality, moisture and temperature for farmers. The profile presents it as a response to climate shocks hitting harvests in southern Africa.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

> UNITED STATES HEALTH FINANCING MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING

- **Zambia Ready To Sign US$1.5 Billion US Health Deal After Specimen-Sharing Clause Is Dropped** — Lusaka Times, 6 October 2026

  Zambia's health minister said the five-year health memorandum with the United States is finalised and due for signature this week, after negotiators removed a clause requiring Zambia to share specimens from its disease-surveillance system. The revised text also addresses health data, intellectual property and benefit sharing; this account puts US funding at US$1.5 billion over five years, tapering annually, and an opposition party wants the final text published before signing.

- **Zambia, US finalise $3.6 billion health deal after public outcry over contentious clauses** — Zambia Monitor, 6 October 2026

  A second account of the Zambian health minister's briefing puts the money to be mobilised for the sector at US$3.6 billion and gives Thursday as the signing day. The minister said the contested clauses on data protection, intellectual property, benefit sharing and specimens have all been reviewed, and that the specimen-sharing obligation is gone entirely.

- **U.S., Zambia sign $2.49-billion health financing pact after removing data and specimen-sharing terms** — Los Angeles Times, 8 October 2026

  Zambia and the United States signed their five-year health financing memorandum in Lusaka after clauses on specimen sharing and patient data were removed. The State Department put it at US$2.49 billion, US$1.52 billion from the United States and US$975 million from Zambia, and Zambia said minerals were not part of it.

- **Zambia and US Sign Five-Year Health MOU and Data Sharing Agreement — Open Zambia** — Open Zambia, 8 October 2026

  Zambia and the United States signed a five-year health memorandum and a data sharing agreement. On this account the agreement exchanges only aggregated, de-identified programme data, with Zambia keeping ownership under its own laws; the health minister said the money will fund 40,000 health workers.

HEALTH DATA SHARING AGREEMENT WITH THE UNITED STATES

- **Zambia and US Sign Five-Year Health MOU and Data Sharing Agreement — Open Zambia** — Open Zambia, 8 October 2026

  Summarised under US / hyperscaler activities.

India activities

INDIA DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE LEARNING MISSION

- **Karnataka Hosts African Union, Five African Nations For Digital Public Infrastructure Exposure Visit** — The Bengaluru Live, 1 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE

  AU plus Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia study Karnataka DPI; UNDP-supported.

- **African Delegations Explore India's Digital Public Infrastructure During UNDP Learning Mission** — Youth Village Zambia, 2 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE

  Five African delegations tour Aadhaar, UPI and DigiLocker on a UNDP South-South mission.

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